Meng Chen

Curriculum Vitae

meng.chen@berkeley.edu // meng-chen.com // @mengchen_24

Research Interests

Human-AI Interaction, Human-Centered AI, Natural Language Processing
Multimodal Agent, Collaborative Agent, Post-Training, Evaluation and Dataset, User Simulation

Education

2026-Now **University of California, Berkeley**, *Berkeley, CA*
Ph.D. in Computer Science
Advisor: Amy Pavel

2020-2024 **University of Notre Dame**, *South Bend, IN*
B.S. *summa cum laude* in Computer Science, Philosophy
Advisor: Toby Jia-Jun Li

Research Experience

05-08/2026 **Autodesk Research**, *San Francisco, CA*
Research Intern
Supervisors: Qian Zhou & Fraser Anderson

2024-2025 **The University of Texas at Austin**, *Austin, TX*
Graduate Researcher
Supervisor: Amy Pavel

06-09/2023 **UC San Diego Design Lab**, *La Jolla, CA*
Visiting Researcher
Supervisor: Haijun Xia

2021-2024 **University of Notre Dame**, *South Bend, IN*
Undergraduate Research Assistant
Supervisor: Toby Jia-Jun Li

Publications (Google Scholar)

† = Equal contribution

Conference Proceedings

C10 **Meng Chen**, Anya Ji, Tsung-Han Wu, Tobias Maringgele, David M. Chan, Alane Suhr, and Amy Pavel. **DigitalCoach: Communication and Grounding Gaps in Human and Agentic Computer Use Coaching**. *In Proceedings of the 2026 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP 2026)*. ★ **Oral (3%)**.

C9 Bhavya Chopra, **Meng Chen**, Rebecca Dang, Chanbin Park, Shreya Shankar, Sepanta Zeighami, Bjoern Hartmann, and Aditya Parameswaran. **Who's Keeping Score? Interactive Steering of LLM-Powered Scoring with Attune**. *In Proceedings of the 39th Annual ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (UIST 2026)*.

C8 **Meng Chen** and Amy Pavel. **TaskArtisan: Designing Composable Generative Widgets for LLM-Assisted Analysis**. *In Proceedings of the 2026 IEEE Symposium on Visual Languages and Human-Centric Computing (VL/HCC 2026)*.

C7 Ujjaini Das, Shreya Kappala, **Meng Chen**, Mina Huh, and Amy Pavel. **Co-Designing Multimodal Systems for Accessible Asynchronous Dance Instruction**. *In Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2026)*.

C6 Yuwen Lu, **Meng Chen**, Qi Zhao, Victor Cox IV, Yang Yang, Meng Jiang, Jay Brockman, Tamara Kay, and Toby Jia-Jun Li. **Crepe: A Mobile Screen Data Collector Using Graph Query**. *In Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2026)*. ★ **Best Paper Honorable Mention**.

C5 **Meng Chen**, Akhil Iyer, and Amy Pavel. **Surfacing Variations to Calibrate Perceived Reliability of MLLM-generated Image Descriptions**. *In Proceedings of the 27th International ACM SIGACCESS Conference on Computers and Accessibility (ASSETS 2025)*.

C4 Aadit Barua†, Karim Benharrak†, **Meng Chen**, Mina Huh, and Amy Pavel. **Lotus: Creating Short Videos From Long Videos With Abstractive and Extractive Summarization**. *In Proceedings of the 30th International Conference on Intelligent User Interfaces (IUI 2025)*.

C3 Ningzhi Tang†, **Meng Chen**†, Zheng Ning, Aakash Bansal, Yu Huang, Collin McMillan, and Toby Jia-Jun Li. **Developer Behaviors in Validating and Repairing LLM-Generated Code Using IDE and Eye Tracking**. *In Proceedings of the 2024 IEEE Symposium on Visual Languages and Human-Centric Computing (VL/HCC 2024)*.

C2 Sangho Suh†, **Meng Chen**†, Bryan Min, Toby Jia-Jun Li, and Haijun Xia. **Luminate: Structured Generation and Exploration of Design Space with Large Language Models for Human-AI Co-Creation**. *In Proceedings of the 2024 ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2024)*.

C1 Toby Jia-Jun Li, Yuwen Lu, Jaylexia Clark, **Meng Chen**, Victor Cox, Meng Jiang, Yang Yang, Tamara Kay, Danielle Wood, and Jay Brockman. **A Bottom-Up End-User Intelligent Assistant Approach to Empower Gig Workers against AI Inequality**. *In Proceedings of the 1st Symposium on Human-Computer Interaction for Work (CHIWORK 2022)*.

Posters, Demos, & Workshops

W4 **Meng Chen**, Anya Ji, Tsung-Han Wu, Tobias Maringgele, David M. Chan, Alane Suhr, and Amy Pavel. **Communication and Grounding Gaps in Human and Agentic Computer Use Coaching**. *In the 3rd Conference on Language Modeling (COLM 2026): Workshop on Agent Behavior (WAB); Learning from Situated and Embodied Interaction (LSEI).* ★ **Oral Spotlight**.

W3 **Meng Chen** and Amy Pavel. **TaskArtisan: Flexible Authoring and Manipulation of Task-specific Interactive Widgets via Sketch and Voice**. *In Adjunct Proceedings of the 38th Annual ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (UIST 2025 Adjunct).*

W2 Ningzhi Tang†, Junwen An†, **Meng Chen**, Aakash Bansal, Yu Huang, Collin McMillan, and Toby Jia-Jun Li. **CodeGRITS: A Research Toolkit for Developer Behavior and Eye Tracking in IDE**. *In Proceedings of the 2024 IEEE/ACM 46th International Conference on Software Engineering: Companion Proceedings (ICSE-Companion 2024).*

W1 Ningzhi Tang†, **Meng Chen**†, Zheng Ning, Aakash Bansal, Yu Huang, Collin McMillan, and Toby Jia-Jun Li. **An Empirical Study of Developer Behaviors for Validating and Repairing AI-Generated Code**. *In 13th Annual Workshop on the Intersection of HCI and PL (PLATEAU 2023).*

Selected Honors & Awards

2026	**Adaption Research Grant**
2025	**Notre Dame-IBM Technology Ethics Lab Award** ($60,000)
2024	**Outstanding Computer Science Senior Award**, *University of Notre Dame*
2024	**2nd Place** ($2,000), *Hesburgh Libraries Hackathon*
2023	**ACM UIST Travel Grant**
2023	**Tau Beta Pi Honor Society**
2023	**Best Insight Award** ($1,000), *American Statistical Association DataFest*
2022	**Best Visualization Award** ($1,000), *American Statistical Association DataFest*
2020-2024	**Stamps Scholar** (4-year full-ride scholarship + $12,000)
2020	**Greater China Scholar**, *University of Notre Dame*

Invited Talks

T3 **Communication and Grounding Gaps in Human and Agentic Computer Use Coaching**
COLM 2026 Workshop on Agent Behavior
San Francisco. Oct. 9, 2026

Berkeley AI Research (BAIR) NLP Workshop
Berkeley. Oct. 5, 2026

T2 **Surfacing Uncertainty in Image Descriptions**
CMU Accessibility Lunch Seminar
Virtual. Nov. 17, 2025

T1 **Structured Generation and Exploration of Design Space with LLMs for Human–AI Co-Creation**

HKUST (GZ) Computational Media and Arts
Virtual. Aug. 7, 2024

Notre Dame NL+ Seminar
Notre Dame, IN. Nov. 27, 2023

Media Coverage

2026 **AI-Generated Image Descriptions are Less Reliable Than They Appear and We Need to Fix It**. *Notre Dame–IBM Tech Ethics Lab*

Teaching & Mentoring

Teaching Assistant

SP 2025 **CS 378: Introduction to Human-Computer Interaction**, UT Austin
FA 2023 **CSE 30151: Theory of Computing**, University of Notre Dame

Students Mentored

2026 **Anika Bhagavatula** (MIMS at UC Berkeley)
2025 **Akhil Iyer** (B.S. in CS at UT Austin)
Ujjaini Das (B.S. in CS at UT Austin → SWE at Apple → CS PhD at UW)
2024 **Aadit Barua** (B.S. in CS and Math at UT Austin)

Service

Program Committee

IUI 2025 26

Area Chair

NeurIPS 2026 Workshop on Interpreting Agent Behavior

Reviewer (30+ papers; * = review awards)

Conference

ACM CHI 2025 26** 27
ACM UIST 2026*
ACM DIS 2026
ACM IUI 2025 26*

Journal

ACM TiiS 2026

Posters / Workshop

NeurIPS	2026
COLM	2026
ACM CHI	2023 24 25 26*
IEEE VIS	2025

Student Volunteer

UIST	2024

Community & Institutional Service

STEM Muse Mentorship Program — Mentor
University of Notre Dame International Student Advisory Board — Director of Communications

Technical Skills

Languages	C/C++, Python, Java, HTML/CSS/JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, and others
Agent Dev	MCP, LangGraph, Claude Agent SDK, HuggingFace, OpenRouter, and others
Libraries	PyTorch, React, Node.js, d3.js, Three.js, Flask, Android Studio, Numpy, and others
UI/UX	Figma, Miro, Quant./Qual. Data Analysis, Participatory Design, and others

---

Last updated: October 12, 2026